Expansion Into New Market

Nordics, UAE, Saudi

Team Members

- Donal Murphy
- Luke Owens
- Rajni Garg
- Sumit Bagla
- Achal Tyagi

Introducing Blynk+: Wellness in Every Sip

Hailing from Ireland, Blynk+ offers functional mushroom drinks crafted for the discerning health-conscious consumer.

Our Product Range :

Focus

Enhances mental clarity, concentration, and cognitive function.

Calm

Promotes relaxation, reduces stress, and supports a peaceful state of mind.

Healthy Energy

Provides sustained vitality and natural energy, supporting endurance.

Key Functional Ingredients

Lion's Mane

Supports cognitive function and memory.

Reishi

Helps manage stress and supports immune health.

Cordyceps

Boosts stamina, athletic performance, and vitality.

Blynk+'s Unique Selling Proposition (USP)

Blynk+ offers premium wellness beverages from Ireland, meticulously formulated with natural ingredients for scientifically-backed functional efficacy. Our sophisticated taste profiles and targeted health benefits provide a delicious and effective way to integrate adaptogenic mushrooms into your daily routine.

The Nordics - Competitor Analysis

Direct Competitors

Company	Description	Products	Country
Shroomwell	Formerly known as Chaga Health, rebranded to Shroomwell in 2023. Large farming capacity across Estonia, Sweden, and the USA. Largest world-wide producer of medicinal mushrooms	<u>Focus State soft drink (€2.40-€3)</u> (1.73g of lion's mane/ ginger for "caffeine free energy"/ Flavour profile: Apple, Honey, Ginger <u>Other products:</u> Focus: Lion's mane/ Reishi/ Chaga/ Cordyceps tincture, infused coffee, capsules and powder.	Country of origin: Estonia
Homie | Wake up synbiotic	Homie – (NEXLY AB, Sweden, founded 2018) Swedish functional beverage brand offering synbiotic energy drinks	<u>Wake Up Synbiotic (€1.60-€2)</u> Combines caffeine from green coffee beans with vitamins, reishi, and chicory root. Flavours: Pineapple/ pear, Strawberry /lemonade, pink grapefruit, Apple/ Elderflower	Country of origin: Sweden
Wihoo	A Swedish functional beverage brand founded in 2023 (Rawnice). Focused on developing natural, nootropic drinks that support energy and cognitive performance.	<u>Wihoo Energy Drink (€2.00–€2.50)</u> A functional energy drink infused with Lion's Mane mushroom for enhanced focus/ Contains natural caffeine, B-vitamins, and electrolytes for clean energy without sugar. Flavours: Graponade, Apple Ocean, Mangolicious, Pineapple & Pear.	Country of origin: Sweden

Indirect Competitors

SAV:D	Carbonated: Naturally caffeinated from guarana. Sugar-free, enriched with electrolytes and vitamins C, D3, B12, K2, and biotin
Maté Maté	Carbonated: Brewed yerba maté leaves for natural caffeine, with antioxidants, theobromine, and polyphenols. Sweetened with agave syrup
Pureness | Natural Energy Drink	Carbonated: Green tea, yerba maté, and guarana extracts for natural caffeine, plus B-vitamins and minerals
Latitude 65	Carbonated: Synthetic caffeine (180 mg per can) functional energy drink with added B3, B5, B6, and B12 vitamins for energy and focus.
Vitamin Well	Still: Vitamin-enriched beverages containing vitamins C, D, E, B6, B12, folic acid, and minerals like zinc and magnesium
Four sigmatic	Powder: Instant coffee with functional mushrooms such as Lion's Mane, Reishi, Chaga, and Cordyceps and B-vitamins
Kääpä mushrooms	Powder & Tinctures: Mushroom extracts made from Lion's Mane, Reishi, Chaga, and Cordyceps
Rå Hygge	Powder: Organic ground coffee infused with Tremella mushroom extract

Distribution Channel Comparison

Food Service (HORECA)

Build Credibility
Establishes the premium price point and sophisticated image

Corporate Wellness (B2B)

Secure Core Volume
Reliable, recurring B2B sales tied to the high-value Nordic wellness trend

D2C (Online)

Brand Education & Loyalty
Essential for storytelling around adopters

Multi-Retailers (Premium)

Mass Market Scale
Achieves maximum reach and volume

Specialty/Gyms

Validate Claims
Targets core, performance-focused users

Quick-Commerce

Instant Discovery
Captures urban impulse purchases for immediate assumptions.

Distribution Partners (Nordics)

Large FMCG Distributors

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humble group.

bonaventura scandza

Mid Size Beverage Importers

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nobeco NORDIC BEVERAGE COMPANY

HAUGEN-GRUPPEN

Flexible Third Party Logistics

SKAN-LOG

TSCHUDI LOGISTICS

The UAE Market

- Key Distribution Partners
- Direct and Indirect Competition
- Competitor Analysis

Large FMCG Distributors (Mezzan/Unitra, Al Maya)

- **Strengths:**
  - Largest reach.
  - Strong supermarket ties and relationships.
  - Strong logistics.
- **Challenges:**
  - Usually look for large volumes and marketing budgets for the product.
  - Likely to want assurances of investment in brand building like BOGOF promos, events, etc.
- **For Blynk:**
  - Unless they can commit to higher shipments and budget for brand activation, this likely isn’t a viable option

Mid-size Beverage Importers (Treasure Islands, Gallery Foods, Golden Grains):

- **Strengths:**
  - Flexible and are used to onboarding new/niche beverage brands.
  - Typically offer “turnkey” services, like customs clearance, warehousing, distribution to retail and cafes/restaurants/hotels.
  - Much more open to smaller orders (pallets rather than containers)
- **Challenges:**
  - Likely to still want confidence that you can supply consistently and invest in some marketing
- **For Blynk:**
  - Very good fit to launch small and test the market before scaling.

Flexible Third Party Logistics/ Trading Houses (Admirals, Far Way, Source International):

- **Strengths:**
  - Operate more like logistics & distribution companies.
  - No demand for huge volumes, some will even work on consignment or hybrid import models
- **Challenges:**
  - Takes much less responsibility for sales and marketing (not as brand building focused as Mezzan or Al Maya)
- **For Blynk:**
  - Good as a tester with smaller batches and can help keep control of how the brand grows

Direct Competition

- Juni
- Kin Euphorics
- Tranquini
- Hiyo

Indirect Competition

- **Probiotics and Gut-Health Sodas**
  - Poppi
- **Functional Powders and Mixables**
  - Chérie Sweet Heart 7 Mushroom Extract Powder
- **Mushroom Coffee**
  - Four Sigmatic
- **Kombucha and Cold Pressed Juices/Vitamin Waters**
  - Remedy
  - Vita Coco

Understanding the Competitive Landscape for Blynk in Saudi Arabia

Navigating the functional mushroom beverage market in Saudi Arabia requires a strategic understanding of both direct and indirect competitors, distribution channels, and market entry opportunities.

Direct Competition: Functional Beverage Pioneers

The functional mushroom space is emerging, but Blynk faces established competition from wellness and adaptogen-based beverages that target similar consumer needs and benefits.

Kin Euphorics

Non-alcoholic, mood-enhancing beverages using adaptogens (Rhodiola Rosea) and nootropics (GABA). Directly competes with Blynk's "Focus" and "Calm" propositions through "social magic" and "portal to peace" positioning.

Availability: Desertcart.com.sa

Hiyo

Marketed as a "social tonic" with ashwagandha, lion's mane, and L-theanine. The lion's mane creates direct ingredient competition with Blynk's "Focus" drink. Promises an uplifting "float" sensation.

Availability: Ubuy.com.sa

Juni

Sparkling adaptogen tea with ashwagandha, lion's mane, and reishi mushrooms. Co-created by Jay Shetty, offering significant wellness credibility. Extremely close formulation match to Blynk.

Availability: Ubuy in Jordan and Qatar markets

Indirect Competitors: Established Wellness Drinks

Kombucha Brands

Saba Kombucha (UAE) and **Lean Kombucha (Saudi)** are established players in fermented wellness drinks with first-mover advantage and strong local brand recognition.
Availability: Danube, Tamimi Markets, Ninja delivery app

Fortified Wellness Drinks

iPRO (UK-based) is a Halal-certified hydration drink fortified with vitamins, competing directly on the "beverage with benefits" platform.
Availability: Carrefour, Al Rabie's distribution network

Functional Mushroom Powders

Four Sigmatic and similar brands indicate an existing consumer base for mushroom-based benefits, competing for the same active ingredient story.
Availability: Noon.com, Ubuy.com.sa

Key Insight: Kombucha brands have already established the fermented wellness drink category, creating both an opportunity and a challenge for Blynk's market entry.

Distribution Landscape: The Gateway to Market Success

Major FMCG Distributors: The Market Titans

Al Jomaih Bottling Plants

Exclusive bottler for entire PepsiCo portfolio (Gatorade, Lipton Iced Tea) in Central & Northern regions. Controls major refrigerated shelf space.

Aujan Coca-Cola Beverages

Powerhouse distributor for Coca-Cola's portfolio including Monster Energy and regional giant Rani. Unmatched market reach across Saudi Arabia.

Al Rabie & Binzagr

Al Rabie partners with wellness brands like iPRO. Binzagr handles massive international portfolios (Unilever, Heinz). Both offer strategic mid-tier opportunities.

Strategic Analysis for Blynk

Large FMCG Distributors

Strengths: Unmatched reach, deep hypermarket relationships

Challenges: Demand large volumes, proven sales data, substantial marketing budgets

For Blynk: End goal, not starting point

Mid-size Specialists

Strengths: Flexible, wellness-focused, turn-key services

Challenges: Smaller overall reach than giants

For Blynk: Ideal strategic fit (Al Rabie)

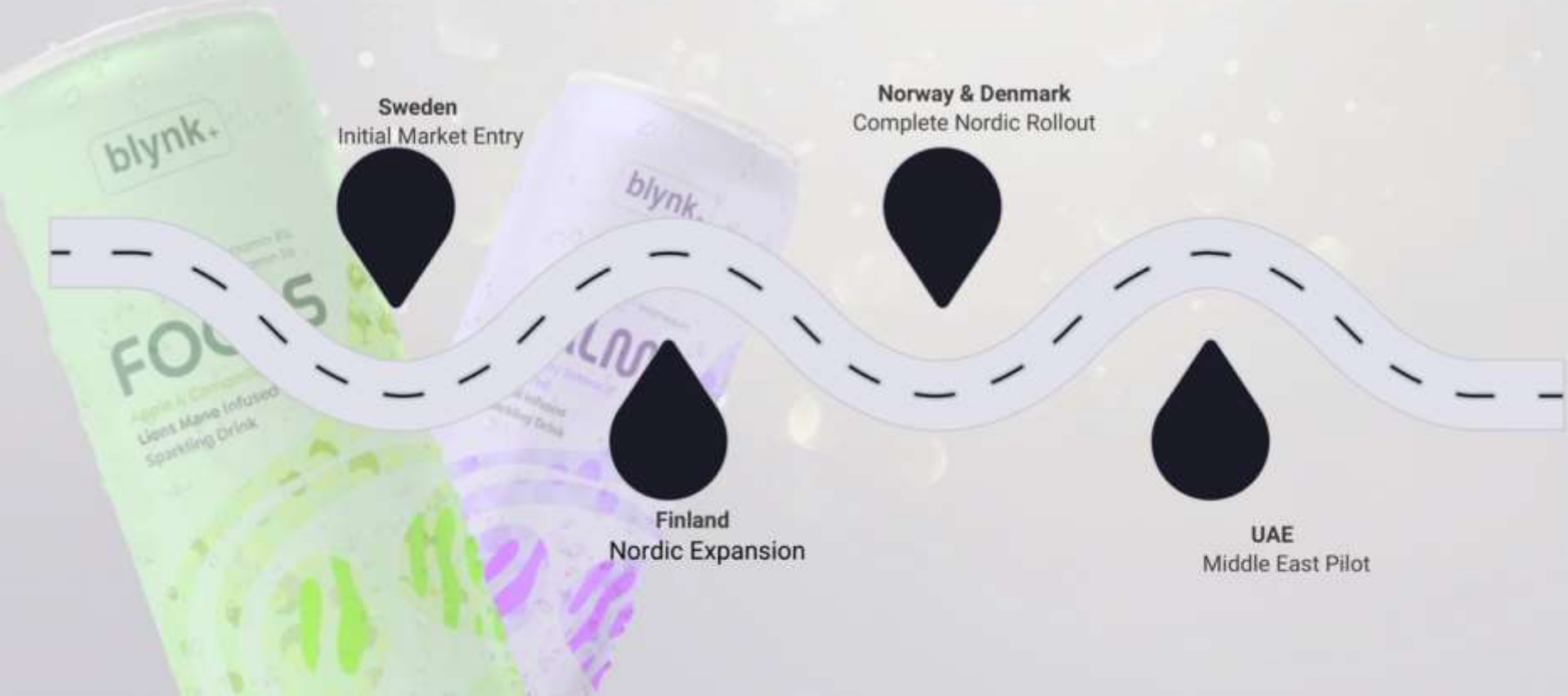
Flexible Trading Houses

Strengths: No minimum volumes, lowest financial risk

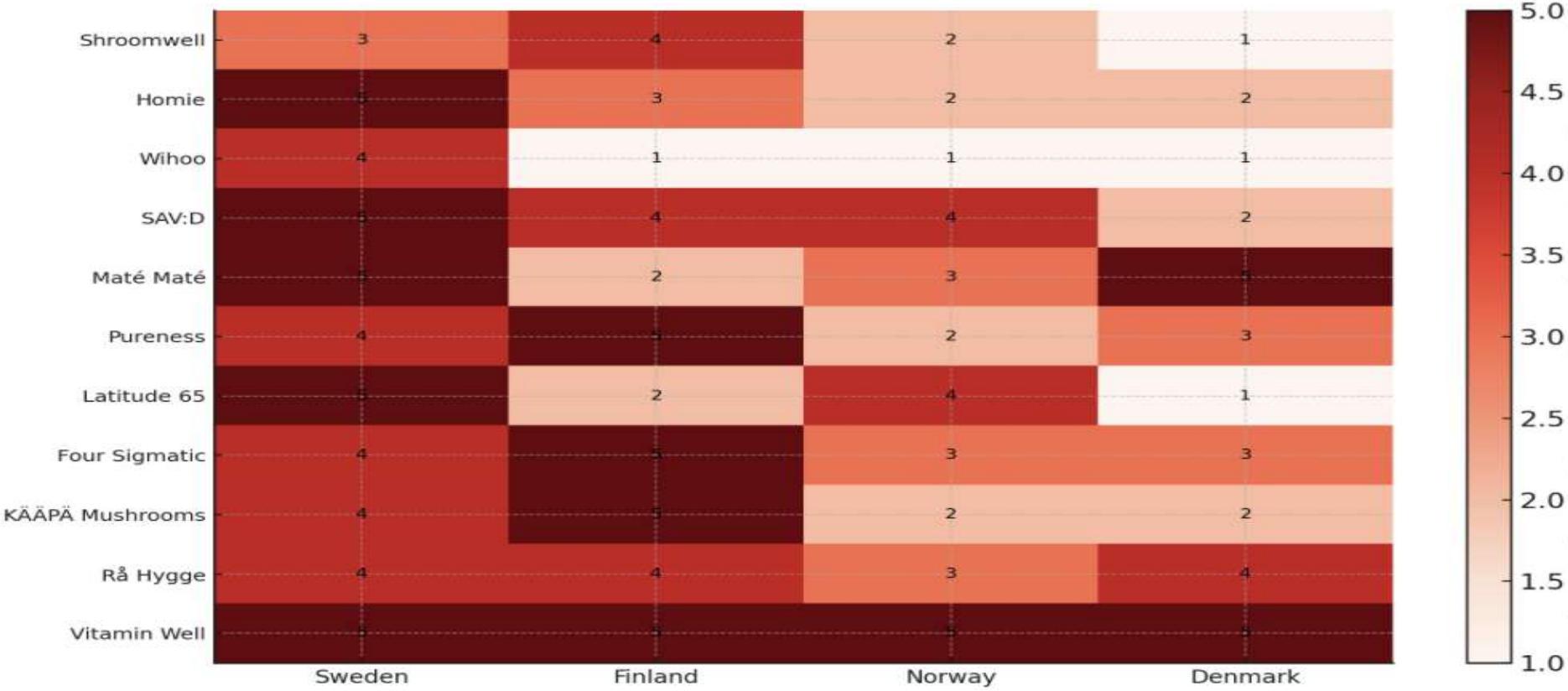
Challenges: Limited brand-building support

For Blynk: Perfect for market testing

Market Entry Prioritization Rankings



Nordic Market & Channel Presence Heatmap



1. Multi retailers 2. Convenience stores 3. Gyms 4. Food service 5. D2C

Market Entry Strategy: Nordics

Market Testing and Entry

- Dark stores & Quick Commerce: Foodora Market (small-scale pilot distribution)
- Low shelf-cost + High visibility
- Leverage Partnership with Holland and Barrett
- ScanTrans Ireland: Road Freight services (pallets & part trailer loads)
- Proof of concept

Scale (D2C & Health Store)

- Health Food Stores: Life & Apotea
- Build D2C Presence

Retail Expansion & Brand Building

- Multi-retailers: ICA & Coop
- Fitness: Nordic Wellness & Fitness 24seven
- Distribution Partner: larger distributor that has the capacity to distribute to multi-chain retailers
- Solera Beverage Group: B2B fulfilment capacity

Nordic Expansion

- Leverage D2C platform to expand into Finland
- Life & Apotea
- D2C: Denmark & Norway

Thank You